

Trying To Help

Arora is a security analyst. Google still doesn't seem to have been able to find a solution to his method of committing click fraud—which he's reported to Google, and to no avail. It seems to us that Arora has been doing this with entirely benign intentions, but as a disclaimer, we must say that we cannot verify every single fact. However, we have little reason, from our interaction with him, that Arora ever had any intentions to make money off AdSense.

We looked up the Net—in fact, we Googled a lot—to see if anything similar to what Manish did has been done before by anyone, and it hasn't, to the best of our knowledge. That said, here's the story.

Naturally, we can't tell you how Arora's "AdSense Crack"—our term—works; but here's what happens. You have a blog. You sign up for an AdSense account—for that, Google first "approves" your blog for the programme. Once they confirm that your blog is fit for an account, your account is activated, and the "Ads by Google" start appearing on your page.



Manish Arora, a security analyst who claims it's very easy to make money off Google AdSense

And then, if you have Arora's script (a set of commands that automate a task), you run it on your site—any site you own. You then send out mails to people you know, inviting them to visit—not your blog—but just about anything they'll find interesting, like a YouTube video, or pics of yours, etc. Those people you mail don't even need to know about the existence of

your blog (where the AdSense ads are).

When they click on your links and watch, say, the video you linked to, Google credits *your* AdSense account!

Yes, you read that right—read it again for the full impact. The AdSense ads are *on your blog*; you send links to, say, videos, to people you know; they click and watch *that* video; and *you* get paid.

Arora can control the scene, as it were: if he chooses to, he can stop all activity by ceasing to send out his mails. Google's bots detect the drop in click activity—and usually disable the account. Arora can then open a new account, and get back into "business."

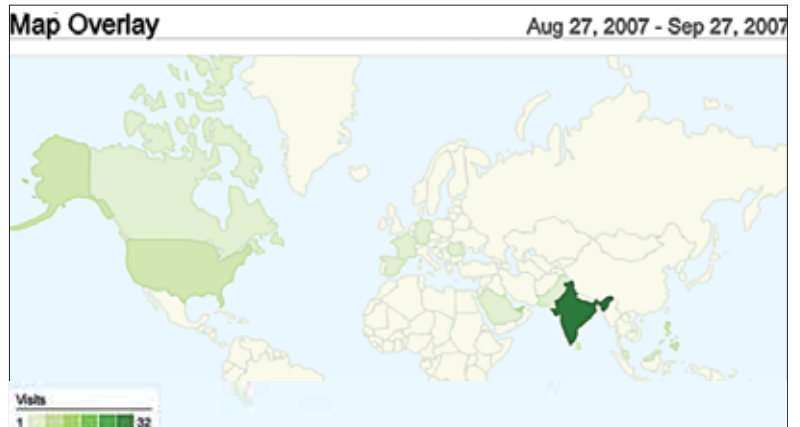
When he first created and ran his script, he "made" thousands of dollars—"made" is in quotes because he never actually took any of the money.

Google says he was lying, and that what he claimed is impossible. Now Arora also tells us he received gifts from Google—two, to be precise—one of which is pictured on this page. It's not for us to decide if the picture has been doctored, but let's just leave it at "We don't now."



One of the gifts Arora claims Google sent him for being a valuable AdSense customer

In November 2006, Arora to Google: "I would be glad to provide you the complete mechanism, which will take one hour a day to produce thousands of dollars a month from AdSense. I would like to explain this model to any of your representatives." And later the same month, from Google to Arora: "We've investigated your claim. At this point, all we can verify is that our automated systems terminated your accounts as a result of your trying to inflate the clicks. This is exactly how the system is designed to work. If (sic) supply us with the code and technical details of the method you mention below, we will investigate further." That was Cory Altheide, Incident Response Lead, Google Security Team. We'll have more to say about this later.



58 visits came from 16 countries/territories

Site Usage					
Visits 58 % of Site Total: 100.00%	Pages/Visit 16.97 Site Avg: 16.97 (0.00%)	Avg. Time on Site 00:05:18 Site Avg: 00:05:18 (0.00%)	% New Visits 84.48% Site Avg: 84.48% (0.00%)	Bounce Rate 41.38% Site Avg: 41.38% (0.00%)	
Country/Territory	Visits	Pages/Visit	Avg. Time on Site	% New Visits	Bounce Rate
India	32	21.47	00:07:02	93.75%	46.88%
United Arab Emirates	7	3.29	00:00:48	71.43%	42.86%
United States	4	20.75	00:06:59	75.00%	0.00%
Philippines	3	1.00	00:00:00	0.00%	100.00%

A map—followed by country-wise figures—of what Arora claims is the report for September 2007 for his AdSense account